★ MURDER AT THE DEADWOOD CANTINA ★

Deadwood Townsfolk

Dancer, Card player, Patron or Traveler — one of the colorful crowd at the tournament party.

How to Play It

Mingle, gossip and stir the pot! Pick a Western name, ask everybody nosy questions, and pass along any juicy rumors you hear. Dancers: sell those dance tickets and sarsaparillas!

For any extra role: pick 3 to use

1. Mitch Maverick! Congratulations on the big win — a businessman beat the poker greats? How'd you do it?
2. Harry, should we be worried about this cantina closin' its doors?
3. Sheriff Sam, got any leads on who robbed the bank earlier this week?
4. Henrietta, that's a mighty fancy necklace. Where'd you get it?
5. Billie, just how bad are the cantina's finances, and who do you blame?
6. Jesse Wales, what brings you to town — and what happened to that hand?

Be Ready If Asked

"Why are you in town?" → Make up a story: passing through to the gold fields, here for the tournament, visiting kin...

"Did you see anything this week?" → "Didn't see the robbery myself, but I've heard plenty of talk. What have YOU heard?"

"Who do you suspect?" → "I've got my eye on a few folks. Buy me a sarsaparilla and I'll tell ya." (Share gossip; don't invent evidence.)

When to use these: After Harry's welcome, pick 3 lines, go find the person each one mentions (or anyone nearby) and work all three into conversation before the lights go out. Tell the host quietly when you're done. After the murder, follow your B envelope.

Conversation starters for the opening of the party • your character sheet always comes first

OBJECTIVES

Starting Objectives:

- Question Harry High-Stakes (the cantina owner) on if he suspects that there was any cheating in the tournament.
- Let Gambling Jack (a card player) know that you were watching him in the tournament.
- Ask Anna Belle (Gambling Jack's backer) how she feels about Jack's loss in the tournament.
- Find out from Poker Alice (the poker dealer) why she let cheating go on in the tournament. (You are certain she saw Gambling Jack cheat as well.)
- Question the other card players if they believe there was cheating in the tournament.
- Ask Billie-The-Bartender (the cantina barmaid) what she knows about Poker Alice.



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Cantina Patron D

As a resident of Deadwood, you are a frequent visitor and a patron of the cantina. Since the town itself is still much in its settlement phase, businesses and residents are just starting to make Deadwood their home. When the Deadwood Cantina was established a little over a year ago, you welcomed the business with open arms. In the past year, you have seen the business of the cantina go from good to great. The Deadwood Cantina has become one of the prime locations to socialize and do business in town. As a resident, you visit the cantina nightly.

Since the town of Deadwood is still a budding frontier town, at times one might find it boring. However, with the Deadwood Poker Tournament in town there has been an air of liveliness that is very refreshing with new faces and continuous action in the cantina.

As a frequent visitor of the cantina, you have noticed a lot about the card players that have come through town this week and they have intrigued you greatly. In particular, you have taken notice of Gambling Jack, one of the final four players in the tournament. Gambling Jack is known throughout the West as the best hand in poker and has not lost a major tournament in five years! Unfortunately, Gambling Jack did not prove to be as good of a player as his reputation suggested since he lost in the final round earlier today. While observing Jack, you also noticed that he has a rather close relationship with Harry High-Stakes. At times in the tournament, you think that you witnessed Gambling Jack cheating, but since Harry did not confront Jack, you wonder if Harry was giving special exceptions to favor his friend and allow Jack to advance as far as he did in the tournament.

While you are not looking forward to the poker tournament ending and Deadwood returning to its slower-paced lifestyle, you are excited to attend the Deadwood Poker Tournament Party. With the grand prize of $100,000 being awarded, there is certain to be a lot of activity at the cantina!

Acting and Dressing Your Part: As a resident of Deadwood, a small frontier town in the Wild West, you are a rough and rugged cowboy or cowgirl. To the party, you will want to wear your western best, which may consist of cowboy boots, a hat, a bandana, shoestring tie, spurs, fringe, chaps and any other accessory you desire. *For more ideas on how to dress and a glossary of wild western words and phrases to use at the party, please see the party tips at www.nightofmystery.com. Simply type in murderatthedeadwoodcantina.com and explore the Guest Info and Costuming sections.*



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